JD-2303

M.A. (Previous) Examination, March-April : 2026

ENGLISH

(Prose)

Paper - III

Time : Three Hours] [*Maximum Marks* : 100

Note : Answer **all** questions. The figures in the right hand margin indicate marks.

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1. Explain **any five** of the following passages with reference to context. $5 \times 4 = 20$

   i) Read not to contradict and confute; nor to believe and take for granted; nor to find talk and discourse; but to weigh and consider.

   ii) But it is not the lie that passeth through the mind, but the lie that sinketh in it, and settleth in it, that doth the hurt; such as we spake of before. But howsoever these things are thus in men's depraved judgements and affections.

   iii) I was born to a small hereditary estate which, according to the tradition of the village where it lies, was bounded by the same hedges and ditches in William the conqueror's time that it is at present, and has been delivered down from father to son whole and entire, without the loss or acquisition of a single field or meadow, during the space of six hundred years.

   iv) I am always very well pleased with a country sunday; and think, if keeping holy the seventh day were only a human institution, it would be the best method that could have been thought of for the polishing and civilizing of mankind. It is certain the country people would soon degenerate into a kind of savages and barbarians.

   v) We are nothing; less than nothing, and dreams. We are only what might have been, and must wait upon the tedious shores of lethe millions of ages before we have existence, and a name.

   vi) I cannot say that the quarrels of men and their wives ever made any great impression upon me or had much tendency to strengthen me in those anti-social resolutions, which I took up long ago upon more substantial considerations. What oftenest offends me at the houses of married persons where I visit, is an error of quite a different description; - it is that they are too loving.

   vii) I may be as uncivil as I may please and the law will protect me against violent retaliation. I may be haughty or boorish and there is no penalty to pay except the penalty of being written down an ill-mannered fellow.

viii) Liberty is not a personal affair only, but a social contract. It is an accommodation of interest. In matters which do not touch anybody else's liberty, of course. I may be as free as I like. If I choose to go down the road in a dressing-gain who shall say me hay? You have liberty to laugh at me, but I have liberty to be in different to you.

ix) So it is with minds. Unless you keep them busy with some definite subject that will bridle and control them, they throw themselves in disorder hither and yon in the vague field of imagination ... And there is no mad or idle fancy that they do not bring forth in the agitation.

x) "That men, however fortune may smile upon them, could never be said to be happy till they had been seen to pass over the last day of their lives", by reason of the uncertainity and mutability of human things, which upon very light and trivial occasions, are subject to be totally changed into a quite contrary condition.

2. Give a critical appreciation of Francis Bacon's essay *Of Truth*. 16

OR

Give a thematic study of Thomas Browne's urn Burial.

OR

What message does Milton convey, through his work 'Areopagitica'.

3. Give a character sketch of Sir Roger. 16

OR

What does Bosewell, say about Dr. Johnson in his work *Life of Dr. Johnson*.

OR

Discuss Benjamin Franklin as an essayist with reference to his work Autobiography.

4. Write critical appreciation of Charles Lamb's Dream Children. 16

OR

Critically evaluate 'on going to journey' by W. Hazlitt.

5. Discuss the characterisation of a poet as given by Thomas Carlyle in his work, *Hero as a Poet*. 16

OR

Give a thematic analysis of Sesame lines by J. Raskin.

OR

Give critical appreciation of 'On saying please' by A.G. Gardiner.

6. What message do, Montague convey in his essay '*of Idleness*'. 16

OR

Discuss Moore's thought, with reference to '*Utopia*' of a perfect civilization and culture.

OR

a) Write short notes on how does Machiavelli view human nature.

b) Discuss in short the class conflict in *The Prince* and its relationship to successful government.